



ALL-AFRICA STUDENTS UNION
UNION PROGRAMME DES ETUDIANTS
الاتحاد جميع الطلاب الأفارقة
Safeguarding students rights since 1992



Association of
African Universities
Association des universités africaines
اتحاد الجامعات الأفريقية



CONCEPT NOTE 2021

EDUCATION ENROLMENT PROGRAMME

For every child;
an education

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The Education Enrolment Programme is an initiative of the All-Africa Students Union that is geared towards getting every child into school. The project is in partnership with the 100 Million Campaign (an organization committed to ensuring that every child is Free, Safe and Educated). The problem that the EEP seeks to address is at the core of AASU concerns. The project reflects AASU's commitment to the democratization of education everywhere on the African continent. The EEP was launched in 2019 and had a part of the first phase implemented in Mankessim, Cape Coast – a community in the Central Region of Ghana. The project has two dimensions to it; the child support and the institutional support dimensions (which will be explained again in this brief document).

The programme is expected to move to the next level where the module will be tested for its effectiveness and will be applied in other areas or communities where most children are out of school. The end game of this project is to ensure that children are in school and are actually learning and have the right tools and environment for learning.

One of the greatest expectations of this programme is that university or tertiary institutions can inculcate this into their extracurricular activities where students may earn extra credits for volunteering for this initiative. This is to ensure that the volunteers take it seriously and also stir the interest of more students to volunteer as mentors.

The next phases of the project may become capital intensive as it is expected that the kids may need some support in terms of stationery, school uniform and the like. As we move in to the next phase of the project, AASU is reaching out to request for more sustainable partnerships that will be also highly mutually beneficial. To ensure ownership of this programme, partners are also encouraged to make inputs and contribute resources in diverse ways that will ensure that the child's education and freedom is kept at the center of this project.

MODULE DRAFT

BRIEF OVERVIEW OF THE PROGRAMME



The module shall have two dimensions as already stated; one dimension will be focused on the development of the child, which will also include providing some form of training and capacity building for volunteers who will be assisting the child, the other dimension will be focused on finding funding options for educational institutions that do not have the adequate facilities to execute their educational duties especially in the less privileged communities. This module is based on the assumption of “students-for-students”; thus, students providing support for their fellow students across the continent. It will be AASU’s duty to find volunteers from tertiary institutions to support the children that will be enrolled into school through this programme.

The module for the EEP considers the following key areas:

- The programme dimensions (child and institutional support)
- Sustainability and partnerships
- Monitoring and Evaluation

THE MODULE

The ultimate aim of any education system is to equip children with the numeracy, literacy and wider skills that they need to realize their potential – and that their countries need to generate jobs, innovation and economic growth.

This dimension of the project focuses on getting children who are not in school to get back in school by enrolling them into public basic schools. The project aims at helping these children who are of school going age but are not in school, to acquire the basic form of education and knowledge. The project requires that students from tertiary institutions will volunteer to mentor the children or to monitor their progress when they are out of school. The EEP Volunteer’s Form will be sent out to collect the needed data of interested volunteers/mentors. Volunteers who meet this criterion /requirement will be selected. The mentors are to be academically sound. These mentors are to provide career guidance, training, teaching, counselling and monitoring to the pupils/mentees at various stages of the project.

THE CHILD SUPPORT

Also, the project will factor teachers from the basic schools (where the kids will be enrolled) to act as supervisors of the pupils/mentees while they are in school. The teachers will monitor and keep track of the child’s development.

Some schools lack resources that enable academic work to happen smoothly. The Education Enrollment Program (EEP) will address these issues by collaborating with organizations and bodies that can help solve these challenges. Some schools lack teachers, teacher learning materials and the others. Also, some of the schools may be in need of technical support in management, training of staff and capacity building. The All-Africa Students Union through the institutional support dimension of the EEP will make some help available to less privileged schools.

The institutional support dimension of the EEP has already commenced, where the Union and the 100 Million have been providing technical and financial support for an educational institution in Mankessim. For example, the Union has assisted the school to streamline its curricula and register with the Ghana Education Service. With the help of the 100 Million Campaign, the Union has also provided some finances to the said school to take care of some of its administrative costs. The school (Key International School) is located in the Central Region of Ghana, Mankessim to be specific.

THE INSTITUTIONAL SUPPORT

PROJECT OUTCOMES

- Enrolment of at least 1000 kids who have been exposed to hazardous work
- At least 100 deprived schools in rural communities have received assistance
- Governments engaged to increase education budgetary allocations for schools in the rural areas



La Nkwantanang District in the Greater Accra Region of Ghana will be the focus of the programme in its next phase to monitor the impact of the module that will be rolled out. Students of the University of Professional Studies Accra (UPSA) and Accra College of Education all being in the district will be considered as possible volunteers and mentors.

Next steps for the pilot phase:

- 1** Identify potential public schools and establish communication leading to the commencement of the programme
- 2** Engage the partners (especially financial partners)
- 3** Identify the kids or children (a maximum of 30) who are out of school within the La Nkwantanang vicinity.
- 4** Screen and select the first batch of volunteers
- 5** Successfully enroll the children
- 6** Hold a brief workshop for the volunteers and connect the volunteers (mentors) with the children (mentees).
- 7** Monitor the progress of the project.

PILOT PHASE

Volunteers will be screened and selected with the help of the University Management. However, it will be opened to all to apply to volunteer at any point in time.

How do we ensure that volunteers/mentors are actually doing their job?

- Through an online platform that will be created, which is expected to be co-hosted by the selected Universities or tertiary institutions, we will be able to monitor the progress of the children they are mentoring.
- The programme coordinators will also be in constant interaction with the teachers or heads of the institutions where the children will be enrolled.
- The volunteers will be accountable to the supervisors from the partner universities.

The programme would require some level of finance and other resources including intensive human capital. It is expected that, most of the human capital for the purposes of this programme will be on voluntary basis while maintaining a permanent project team.

To ensure that the programme is continually running innovatively and with the necessary technical know-how and financial support, the union will work hand in hand with the following partners:



100 Million Campaign (already a working partner)

The 100 Million campaign is a youth-led call to action for a world where all young people are free, safe and educated. They mobilize young people to end violence against children, eradicate child labour, and ensure education, breaking the cycles of illiteracy, poverty and violence for good. It was launched in India at the end of 2016, by 6,000 young people, standing side by side with Nobel Peace Laureate, and renowned child rights activist, Kailash Satyarthi. With support from the Kailash Satyarthi Children's Foundation, the campaign has worked to bring together impassioned young activists from every background to mobilise and advocate for the rights of the world's most excluded children. We believe that 100 Million campaign as a partner can provide critical advocacy and financial support to ensure the execution of this project.



**Association of
African Universities**
Association des universités africaines
اتحاد الجامعات الإفريقية

Association of African Universities

The Association of African Universities (AAU) is an international non-profit, non-governmental organization created by African universities to promote cooperation between them on the one hand, and between them and the international academic community on the other. AAU is the Implementing arm of the African Union Commission on Higher Education matters and the Coordinator of the Continental Education Strategy for Africa (CESA-16-25). Created in 1967, the AAU is also the voice of higher education in Africa. It aims to improve the quality of African higher education, and to strengthen its contribution to Africa's development by supporting the core functions of higher education institutions and facilitating critical reflection and consensus building on issues affecting higher education in Africa.

Ministries of Education

The programme will be executed at both country and continental level. The ministry who is in charge of education in their countries will provide advice on how the project can successfully be executed in their respective country. They can also provide help on how to acquire logistics for the successful execution of the programme.

Ministries of Gender, Children and Social Protection

Since the ministry is in charge of children and the programme is about protecting the child and giving them a future by sending them back to school, the ministry will provide technical advice on how best the child can be protected from child labor whiles they are being enrolled.

Selected Tertiary Institutions

(for now University of Professional Studies, Accra and Accra Technical University)

The selected tertiary schools can provide technical and sometimes financial support to enable the programme to be successfully implemented. The students from the respective schools will serve as human capital by volunteering as mentors to mentor the children on other issues.

National Student Unions

The union is a student organization in countries which comprise of students with their leaders. They fight for their right and betterment of the educational system. Since it is a body of all students, they will provide technical advice on how the programme can successfully be implemented.

SUSTAINABILITY AND PARTNERSHIP

MONITORING AND EVALUATION

To ensure the effectiveness of the programme, the project will be monitored and evaluated on the following basis:

- Termly assessment of the performance of the children, by taking feedback from their teachers and analysing their termly report cards.
- Daily reports from volunteers or reports from volunteers anytime they are in touch with their mentees.
- Quarterly assessments.
- When the project finally takes off continent-wide, the Union will be working through its members (the National Student Unions) to enhance feedback and monitoring.

The week 1 commences from June 2021:

	Identify public schools within La Nkwantanang	Engage Partners (including UPSA, AAU and Accra College of Education)	Scout for non-school going kids	Select volunteers	Enroll children	Hold a workshop for volunteers at the AASU Office	Monitor the progress
Week 1							
Week 2							
Week 3							
Week 4							
Week 5							
Week 6							
Week 7							
Week 8							
Week 9							
Week 10							
Week 11							
Week 12							
Week 13							

TIMELINE

ABOUT THE LEAD ORGANISATION (AASU)

AASU is the largest student movement in Africa and a very dominant force on the Continent and beyond. The All-Africa Students Union (AASU) organizes all students in Africa from the basic level to Institutions of higher learning; in essence, the Union is the umbrella organization for all students of Africa. Since its inception in 1972, AASU now has presence in 54 Countries in Africa. As the Continent's largest students group, AASU played an important role in the struggle against colonialism and the ending of apartheid. Today, AASU is at the forefront of the fights for equal access to quality education, quality assurance in higher education, harmonization of higher education systems with key emphasis on mobility of students and academics, and comparability of qualifications, democratic governance, defending students' rights, promotion of gender and African culture, sustainable development, entrepreneurship, fostering of academic freedom, freedom of research and autonomy of higher institutions of learning, and the promotion of peace and democratic values, and other noteworthy objectives. In the year 2000, the United Nations (UN) awarded AASU a certificate of merit in recognition of the Union's efforts at advancing students' rights and championing the democratization of education across the African Continent.

Our strategic approach is to address the crucial issues affecting African students and young people, as such, we have identified Seven (7) Strategic Priorities to guide our work at the Secretariat in accordance with the aims and objectives of the Union.

AASU's Strategic Priorities are fully aligned to the UN and AU's development priorities as articulated in the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and Agenda 2063 respectively. In addition, these priorities complement the global efforts to build a relevant contemporary human capital, capable of fitting into the global citizen ecosystem.

STRATEGIC PRIORITIES OF THE ALL-AFRICA STUDENTS UNION

The Seven (7) Strategic Priorities of the Union are:

- GENDER ADVOCACY
- ENVIRONMENT & CLIMATE ACTION
- DEMOCRACY & GOOD GOVERNANCE
- CAPACITY BUILDING
- MIGRATION & MOBILITY
- EDUCATION & STUDENTS RIGHTS
- PAN-AFRICANISM & AFRICAN CULTURE

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